

L2 - 5.4. SharePoint Online Monitoring

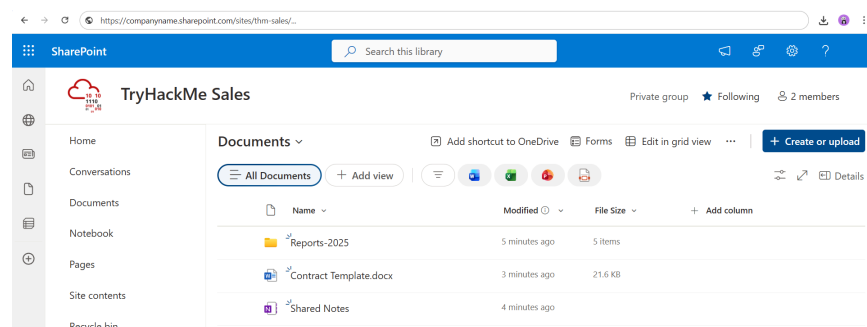
Task 1 - Introduction

SharePoint Online is one of the most targeted M365 services, as it often stores sensitive files and can be used to propagate the attack. This room will explore the most common attack scenarios on SharePoint Online and explain how to monitor for them as a SOC team.

Task 2 - SharePoint Overview

SharePoint Online is a service within the Microsoft 365 suite that lets you store, organize, share, and access corporate information through a web browser. It is widely used by organizations that use the Microsoft stack to keep team documentation and collaborate on documents, spreadsheets, and presentations. It is basically a business version of Google Drive and Microsoft OneDrive:

- **Google Drive:** A cloud service to store and collaborate on files through the web
- **Microsoft OneDrive:** Microsoft's analogue of Google Drive, built for personal files
- **Microsoft SharePoint:** A more powerful version of OneDrive for corporate use



For future reference, SharePoint organizes data into top-level containers called **sites**, where each site is tied to an email group (e.g. **sales@tryhackme.thm**) and contains files, folders, or web pages. Also, note

that there is an on-premises version of SharePoint. It is rarely used and relies on Active Directory authentication. This room will only explain SharePoint Online, a cloud-based service.

SharePoint and M365

SharePoint is deeply integrated into the Microsoft 365 suite. For example, authentication to SharePoint is performed via an Entra ID login, so if an adversary breaches a corporate Microsoft account with the right permissions, they automatically get access to all the SharePoint files the victim has access to. Fortunately, you can always audit SharePoint logins in the Entra ID console:

Date	Request ID	User	Application	Status	Sign-in error co...	IP address
1/29/2026, 4:00:27 PM	15c25fcd-025b-4699...	Emily Turner	SharePoint Online W...	Success	0	2a02:2a4f
1/29/2026, 4:00:26 PM	ff7b0b29-b69f-443e...	Emily Turner	Office 365 SharePoi...	Success	0	2a02:2a4f
1/29/2026, 4:00:14 PM	b2c76576-6844-4a9...	Emily Turner	Office 365 SharePoi...	Interrupted	50072	2a02:2a4f
1/29/2026, 3:51:02 PM	eb11a738-6864-491...	Emily Turner	SharePoint Online W...	Success	0	2a02:2a4f

SharePoint Risks

- IT sites may contain network diagrams, application source code, or even keys
- Finance sites may contain internal reports and confidential documents
- Sales sites typically contain big spreadsheets of partners and customers
- In short, SharePoint is one of the most important M365 services to monitor

Answer the questions below

Which of the mentioned Microsoft services is like SharePoint, but for personal use?

OneDrive

How do you call the SharePoint top-level container that holds objects, such as files?

Site

Task 3 - SharePoint Logging

Same as with other M365 services, you need to combine Entra ID and M365 logs to monitor SharePoint properly. Entra ID sign-in logs show authentication attempts to SharePoint, and M365 unified audit logs show file operations: access, modification, and sharing. Let's start with the sign-in logs. Below is a chain of sign-in events you will see during a legitimate SharePoint access of Emily Turner:

1 index=m365 sourcetype="azure:aad:signin"
2 | table _time userPrincipalName appDisplayName ipAddress deviceDetail.browser status.errorCode

✓ 18 events (1/29/26 2:00:00.000 PM to 1/29/26 3:00:00.000 PM) No Event Sampling ▾ Job ▾ II ▮ ↻ ⚙ ⬇ 🔊 Verbose Mode ▾

Events (18) Patterns **Statistics (18)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page ▾ ↗ Format ▾ Preview: On

_time	userPrincipalName	appDisplayName	ipAddress	deviceDetail.browser	status.errorCode
2026-01-29 14:00:06	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	OfficeHome	2a02:2a40:[...]	Edge 144.0.0	50140
2026-01-29 14:00:08	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	OfficeHome	2a02:2a40:[...]	Edge 144.0.0	0
2026-01-29 14:00:26	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	Office 365 SharePoint Online	2a02:2a40:[...]	Edge 144.0.0	0
2026-01-29 14:00:27	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	SharePoint Online Web Client Extensibility	2a02:2a40:[...]	Edge 144.0.0	0
2026-01-29 14:00:37	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	Office365 Shell WCSS-Client	2a02:2a40:[...]	Edge 144.0.0	0

The first two events from the image indicate that Emily logged in to the M365 home portal (**m365.cloud.microsoft**). From there, she accessed the corporate SharePoint portal. The last event, login to Office365 Shell WCSS-Client, occurs automatically whenever a user navigates in M365 apps. If you want to monitor SharePoint logins, focus on sign-in events **#3** and **#4**. Also, please remember that logins from IPv6 can still be malicious. Never assume that IPv6 equals False Positive!

SharePoint File Operations

After signing in, Emily will interact with the site. You would see all her activities in M365 audit logs, with the **Workload** field always set to **SharePoint**. Let's see the simplest example, access to the Contract Templates document through SharePoint:

```
{
  "CreationTime": "2026-01-29T15:08:32",
  "OrganizationId": "755c8cb5-4ddf-4c5e-[...]", // MS365 tenant ID
  "Operation": "FileAccessed", // Event name (action)
  "Workload": "SharePoint", // Target service
```

```

vice
  "UserId": "emily.turner@tryhackme.thm",           // Source use
r email
  "AuthenticationType": "OAuth",
  "Site": "66c03890-ed18-42b3-[...]",               // SharePoint
site ID
  "UserAgent": "MSWAC",                             // Internal S
harePoint user-agent
  "ClientIP": "20.54.165.63",                       // IP of M365
server, not Emily's!
  "DeviceDisplayName": "20.54.165.63",              // Again, thi
s is not Emily's IP!
  "SourceRelativeUrl": "Shared Documents",          // Folder of
the file
  "SourceFileName": "Contract Template.docx",       // Accessed f
ile name
  "SourceFileExtension": ".docx",
  "ApplicationDisplayName": "WebWord",
  "SiteUrl": "https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/thm-sale
s/",
  "ObjectId": "https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/thm-sal
es/Shared Documents/Contract Template.docx"
}

```

The event below follows a similar M365 log structure, where Workload, Operation, and UserId fields are always present, and other fields depend on the event. Note that you shouldn't blindly trust IPs and user agents in the logs, as they often refer to SharePoint servers rather than the actual clients.

- `FileCreated` / `FileUploaded` : Useful to track suspicious file uploads
- `FileDeleted` / `FileRecycled` : Essential for audit and compliance purposes
- `FileAccessed` / `FileDownloaded` : Helpful for many types of cyber incidents

File Sharing in SharePoint

Another important monitoring aspect is file sharing. Microsoft reports both when sharing settings were changed and whenever a sharing link was used. That's

great since file sharing can be abused in various scenarios that you will learn in the next tasks. Let's assume Emily shared a sensitive file with an external, untrusted email. You can start the hunt as:

List SharePoint sharing events (Splunk)

```
index=* Workload=SharePoint Operation IN(AddedToSecureLink, AnonymousLinkCreated)
```

If there is a match, you will see which file was shared (**ObjectId**) and with whom (**TargetUserOrGroupName**). Note that it's only valid for external sharing. For internal sharing, better hunt for the **SharingSet** events. Next, you might want to check if the target user has already accessed the link, or if you have time to revoke the sharing before it's too late:

List SharePoint sharing events (Splunk):

```
index=* Workload=SharePoint Operation IN(SecureLinkUsed, AnonymousLinkUsed)
```

In Splunk, you can analyze both events in a single timeline. Below is an example showing how Emily shared a sensitive file with an external user (**AddedToSecureLink**), and how the user accessed the file a minute later (**SecureLinkUsed**). In most cases, these events are also followed by a **FileAccessed** event.

The screenshot shows a Splunk search interface with the following query: `index=m365 Workload=SharePoint Operation IN(AddedToSecureLink, SecureLinkUsed) | eval TargetId=lower(TargetUserOrGroupName) | table _time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId`. The results table displays two events:

_time	Operation	UserId	TargetId	ObjectId
2026-01-29 23:14:36	AddedToSecureLink	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	charlie@shadycorp.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/thm-sales/Shared Documents/Customers2026.xlsx
2026-01-29 23:15:48	SecureLinkUsed	urn:spo:guest#charlie@shadycorp.thm		https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/thm-sales/Shared Documents/Customers2026.xlsx

Practice: You will need both data sources from the `index=practice` query. Search for **All Time** and investigate the activity of Emily Turner.

Answer the questions below

Refer to the Entra ID sign-in logs (**azure:aad:signin**). What is the event ID that confirms Emily's login to SharePoint?

22192ff2-272a-458c-8fac-7155db417700

```
index=practice sourcetype="azure:aad:signin" appDisplayName="Office 365 SharePoint Online"
```

1 index=practice sourcetype="azure:aad:signin" appDisplayName="Office 365 SharePoint Online"

✓ 1 event (before 8/20/26 11:18:50.000 AM) No Event Sampling ▾ Job ▾

Events (1) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Timeline format ▾ - Zoom Out + Zoom to Selection x Deselect

Format ▾ Show: 20 Per Page ▾ View: List ▾

	i	Time	Event
>		2/9/26 5:55:52.000 PM	{ [-] appDisplayName: Office 365 SharePoint Online appId: 00000003-0000-0ff1-ce00-000000000000 appliedConditionalAccessPolicies: [[+]] clientAppUsed: Browser conditionalAccessStatus: success correlationId: 875bf5a1-b0c1-0000-a921-8a7cd9c0d4b7 createdDateTime: 2026-02-09T17:55:52Z deviceDetail: { [+] } id: 22192ff2-272a-458c-8fac-7155db417700 ipAddress: 2a02:2a40:27ef:3b00:81c9:eed:b5e6:5b23 isInteractive: true location: { [+] } resourceDisplayName: Office 365 SharePoint Online resourceId: 00000003-0000-0ff1-ce00-000000000000 ...

SELECTED FIELDS
a host 1
a source 1
a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS
a action 1
a app 1
a appDisplayName 1
a appld 1
a appliedConditionalAccessPolicies[].displayname 1
a appliedConditionalAccessPolicies[].enforcedGrantControls[] 1
a appliedConditionalAccessPolicies[].id 1
a appliedConditionalAccessPolicies[].result 1

Move on to the SharePoint logs (**o365:management:activity**). What PDF file did Emily upload to the SharePoint?

Instructions.pdf

```
index=practice sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation=FileUploaded
| table _time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId
```

The screenshot shows the Splunk Enterprise web interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'splunk>enterprise' and various menu items like 'Messages', 'Settings', 'Activity', 'Help', and 'Find'. Below this is a 'Search & Reporting' section with tabs for 'Search', 'Analytics', 'Datasets', 'Reports', 'Alerts', and 'Dashboards'. The 'Search' tab is active, showing a 'New Search' page. The search query entered is: `index=practice sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation=FileUploaded | table _time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId`. The results show 4 events. The table below represents the data shown in the results.

_time	Operation	UserId	TargetId	ObjectId
2026-02-09 17:56:43	FileUploaded	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm		https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/development/SitePages/CollabHome.aspx
2026-02-09 17:58:07	FileUploaded	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm		https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/development/Shared Documents/Engineering Contractors/Instructions.pdf
2026-02-09 17:58:26	FileUploaded	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm		https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/development/Shared Documents/Engineering Contractors/squid.zip
2026-02-09 17:59:34	FileUploaded	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm		https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/development/Shared Documents/Engineering Contractors/nodejs.zip

For sharing query:

```
index=practice sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation
IN(AddedToSecureLink, AnonymousLinkCreated) | eval TargetId
=lower(TargetUserOrGroupName)
| table _time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId
```

Soon after, Emily shared the PDF with an external user. What is the email of the target user?

ahmad.khan@opendoor.thm

1	index=practice sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation IN(AddedToSecureLink, AnonymousLinkCreated) eval TargetId=lower(TargetUserOrGroupName)					All time	Q
2	table_time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId						

✓ 1 event (before 8/20/26 11:31:08.000 AM) No Event Sampling ▾ Job ▾ || ▮ → 🖨 ⬇ ⚙ Smart Mode ▾

Events Patterns **Statistics (1)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page ▾ Format ▾ Preview: On

_time ▾	Operation ▾	UserId ▾	TargetId ▾	ObjectId ▾
2026-02-09 18:02:40	AddedToSecureLink	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	ahmad.khan@opendoor.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/development/Shared Documents/Engineering Contractors/Instructions.pdf

Task 4 - Detecting Data Exfiltration

SharePoint is one of the primary targets for threat actors. After an account is compromised, the adversary may explore the contents of their SharePoint and exfiltrate files of interest, such as contracts, reports, internal wiki pages, or source code. Depending on the type and size of data, the adversary may:

- Open the file in the browser and read it without downloading. Generates the **FileAccessed** event for every file.
- Download the needed file or folder. Generates a **FileDownloaded** or similar event for every downloaded file.
- Share the file with anyone and access it anonymously via a link. Still generates share events and **FileAccessed**.

Data Exfiltration via GUI

The simplest way to view SharePoint data is through the M365 portal. Like legitimate users, attackers can browse folders, open files, and download sensitive data. Unfortunately, if attackers act cautiously, their activity is hard to distinguish from normal SharePoint usage. Still, you can alert on a spike in **FileDownloaded** events, since downloading a folder generates one event per file inside. The search below shows how a single **Reports-2025** folder download resulted in five events:

`index=m365 Workload=SharePoint Operation=FileDownloaded`

```
1 | stats count values(SourceFileName) by SiteUrl, SourceRelativeUrl, UserId
2 | where count >= 5
```

5 events (1/29/26 10:00:00.000 PM to 1/29/26 11:00:00.000 PM) No Event Sampling Job || ▢ ↶ ⚙️ ⬇️ 🔊 Verbose Mode ▼

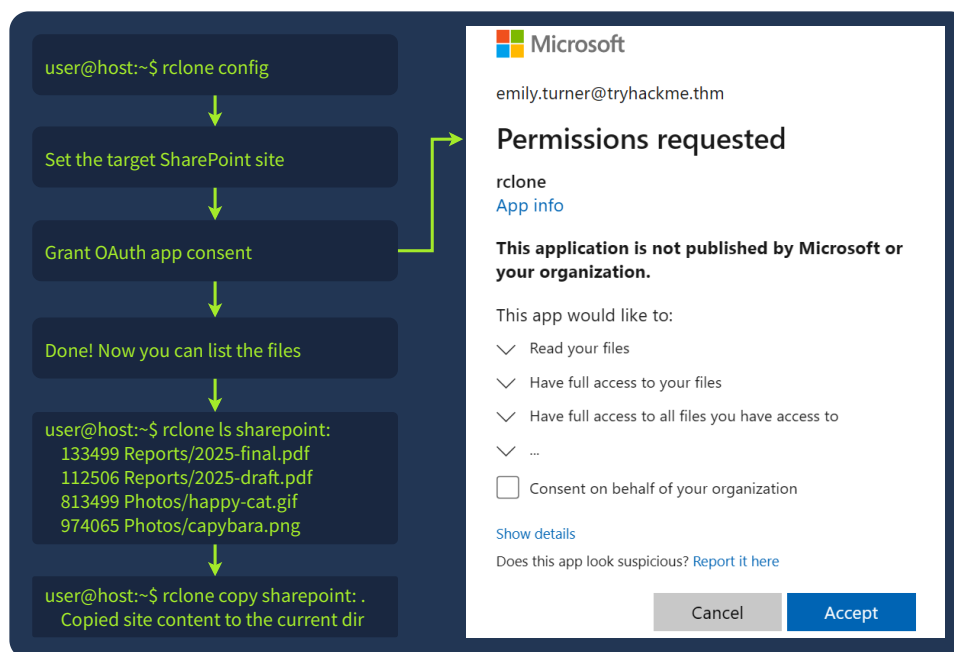
Events (5) Patterns **Statistics (1)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page ▼ Format Format Preview: On

SiteUrl ↕	SourceRelativeUrl ↕	UserId ↕	count ↕	values(SourceFileName) ↕
https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/thm-sales/	Shared Documents/Reports-2025	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	5	Q1 [Final].docx Q2 [Final].docx Q3 [Final].docx Quota.xlsx Sales Presentation.pptx

Data Exfiltration via App

The M365 portal does not allow full site export and does not support advanced search. Therefore, if attackers want to dump gigabytes of data, they must resort to external tools. Examples include the OneDrive app, the Rclone CLI utility, and many more paid solutions that allow you to sync SharePoint content with your local PC or another cloud location. For Rclone, the data export will look like this:



Regular users rarely use external applications to interact with SharePoint, especially CLI tools like Rclone. Thus, you can start by alerting on new applications on a per-user basis. To do this, focus on the **ApplicationDisplayName** and **UserAgent** fields, which are present in all file-

related records. Below are the logs generated when running the Rclone commands shown in the illustration above:

_time	UserId	Operation	ApplicationDisplayName	ApplicationId	UserAgent
2026-01-29 22:15:27	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	FileDownloaded	rclone	b15665d9-eda6-4092-8539-0eec376afd59	rclone/v1.72.1
2026-01-29 22:15:26	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	FileDownloaded	rclone	b15665d9-eda6-4092-8539-0eec376afd59	rclone/v1.72.1
2026-01-29 22:15:26	emily.turner@tryhackme.thm	FileDownloaded	rclone	b15665d9-eda6-4092-8539-0eec376afd59	rclone/v1.72.1

List Rclone downloads (Splunk):

```
index=* rclone Operation=FileDownloaded
| table _time UserId Operation ApplicationDisplayName ApplicationId UserAgent
```

Answer the questions below

Which M365 event is generated every time the file is downloaded?

FileDownloaded

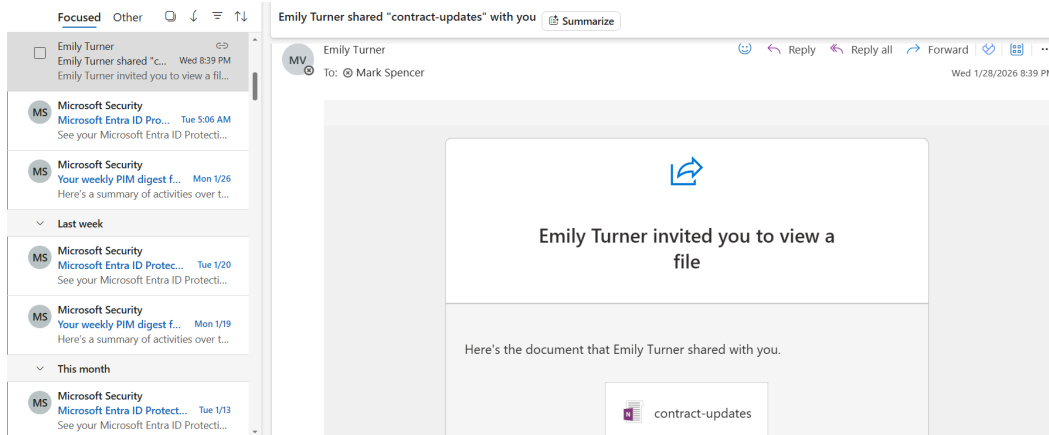
Which M365 field can you use to identify the application behind the event?

ApplicationDisplayName

Task 5 - Detecting SharePoint Abuse

SharePoint as an Attack Tool

Imagine you are an attacker who has compromised the account of a B2B Sales Lead. You discover a CSV file containing hundreds of partner email addresses, including contacts from large, well-known companies. How can this be abused? You could launch a phishing campaign on all addresses while impersonating the Sales Lead. And to bypass anti-phishing controls, you can send the emails via SharePoint!



Whenever you share a file via SharePoint, the recipient receives a notification email sent from your account. An attacker can abuse this by creating a document inside the compromised SharePoint (often a **OneNote** file), embedding malicious instructions or links, and sharing it with targeted victims. Because both email servers and users usually trust these notifications, SharePoint becomes a tool for distributing malware or phishing. The screenshot above is a classic example of this attack.

Detecting SharePoint Abuse

#	Response Action	Splunk Search Example
1	Find and quarantine the malicious file that was shared	N/A (Read the sharing email and note the file name inside)
2	Identify and disable patient zero, the user account that uploaded the file	<pre>index=m365 Operation IN(FileUploaded, FileCreated) ObjectId=*BADFILE* table _time UserId Operation ObjectId</pre>
3	Identify and notify all users with whom the malicious file was shared	<pre>index=m365 Operation IN(AddedToSecureLink, SharingSet) ObjectId=*BADFILE* table _time UserId TargetUserOrGroupName ObjectId</pre>
4	Immediately contact (e.g., call) those who have already opened the file	<pre>index=m365 Operation IN(*LinkUsed, FileAccessed) ObjectId=*BADFILE* stats values(UserId)</pre>

If you fail to notify all sharing recipients in time, your company may start a supply chain attack. For example, if an IT firm in Europe is breached, attackers may share

malware with its retail clients in the USA. If lateral movement succeeds, the same attack can then spread from the retailer to its supplier, a larger manufacturer in Asia. It is essential to secure not only yourself, but also all partners and clients your company could affect.

Advanced SharePoint Abuse

Note that M365 logging can be confusing at times, and attackers are often very creative. For example, instead of creating a new file, they may backdoor an existing one (which results in a **FileModified** event). They can also lure other users into creating and sharing malware, which will mess up the logs. This is why, during an incident, you should review all activities in a chronological timeline instead of simply searching for specific events or indicators.

Answer the questions below

| Which file type is often abused to share phishing through SharePoint?

OneNote

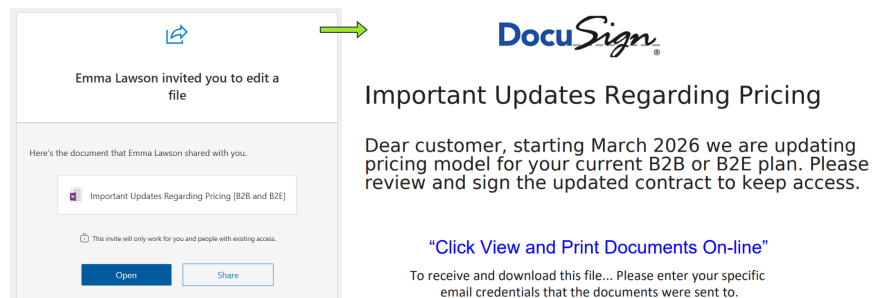
| Which event is generated when someone shares a file with an external user?

AddedToSecureLink

Task 6 - Real-World Scenario

The phone rings, it's the SOC manager:

"Hey, quick one: our CEO, Michael, wants us to look into a OneNote file that was just shared by Emma Lawson, our Head of Customer Relationships. The file seems suspicious, and he can't recall approving any pricing updates. Before your shift ends, could you take a look and make sure everything is clean? I'll forward you the screenshots Michael sent me; check your inbox:"



Practice: For this task, start with the `index=challenge` query and search for **All Time**.

Answer the questions below

When did Michael open the shared OneNote file?

2026-02-03 12:49:44

```
index=challenge Operation IN(*LinkUsed, FileAccessed)
| table _time UserId TargetUserGroupName ObjectId
```

2026-02-03 12:49:44	michael.els@tryhackme.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/marketing/Shared Documents/Important Updates Regarding Pricing [B2B and B2E]/Open Notebook.onetoc2
2026-02-03 12:49:44	michael.els@tryhackme.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/marketing/Shared Documents/Important Updates Regarding Pricing [B2B and B2E]/Open Notebook.onetoc2

With which three external emails did Emma share the file, too?

li.wang@tryhatme.thm, susan.moore@deceptitech.thm,
william.baker@probablyfine.thm

```
index=challenge sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operati
on IN(AddedToSecureLink, Anonymous LinkCreated) | eval Target
Id=lower(TargetUserOrGroupName)
| table_time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId
```

1	index=challenge sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation IN(AddedToSecureLink, Anonymous LinkCreated) eval TargetId=lower(TargetUserOrGroupName)				
2	table _time Operation UserId TargetId ObjectId				

✓ 3 events (before 8/20/26 12:11:12.000 PM) No Event Sampling ▾ Job ▾ || ▮ → 🗑

Events (3) Patterns **Statistics (3)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page ▾  Format ▾  Preview: On

_time ↕	Operation ↕	UserId ↕	TargetId ↕	ObjectId ↕
2026-02-03 12:47:19	AddedToSecureLink	emma.lawson@tryhackme.thm	li.wang@tryhatme.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint Documents/Important Updates B2E]
2026-02-03 12:47:19	AddedToSecureLink	emma.lawson@tryhackme.thm	susan.moore@deceptitech.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint Documents/Important Updates B2E]
2026-02-03 12:47:19	AddedToSecureLink	emma.lawson@tryhackme.thm	william.baker@probablyfine.thm	https://tryhackme.sharepoint Documents/Important Updates B2E]

One of the users from Question 2 already accessed the malicious file.
What **CorrelationId** value proves that the sharing link has been opened?

945ff3a1-e059-0000-b054-6e5ee5ff2a81

```
index=challenge sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation IN(LinkUsed, FileAccessed) ObjectId="https://tryhackme.sharepoint.com/sites/marketing/Shared Documents/Important Updates Regarding Pricing [B2B and B2E]*"
| table _time UserId TargetUserGroupName ObjectId CorrelationId
```

Before sharing the malicious file, attackers reviewed Emma's SharePoint. Which PowerPoint presentation file did they exfiltrate?

THM PoC B2E.pptx

```
index=challenge sourcetype="o365:management:activity" Operation=FileDownloaded
| table _time Operation UserId object
```

According to Entra ID logs, from which city was the malicious login performed?

Amsterdam

```
index=challenge sourcetype="azure:aad:signin"  
| table _time location.city userPrincipalName addDisplayName  
ipAddress deviceDetail.browser status.errorCode
```

Task 7 - Conclusion

With this final knowledge piece on SharePoint monitoring, you are now equipped to onboard, monitor, and protect Entra ID and M365 environments against a wide range of emerging threats. We hope you enjoyed both this room and the entire module!

SharePoint Online Monitoring: Detecting Cloud Data Exfiltration & Abuse

 **SharePoint Online is one of the most important Microsoft 365 services to monitor.** It stores corporate documents, reports, source code, customer information, and other sensitive data, making it an attractive target for attackers. Because SharePoint authentication is integrated with Entra ID, a compromised Microsoft account can potentially provide access to the SharePoint resources available to that user.

 **Effective monitoring requires combining Entra ID sign-in logs with Microsoft 365 Unified Audit Logs.** Entra ID provides visibility into authentication activity, while M365 audit logs expose file operations such as access, upload, download, modification, deletion, and sharing.

 **File activity can provide valuable detection signals.** Events such as `FileCreated`, `FileUploaded`, `FileAccessed`, and `FileDownloaded` help establish what happened to a document and when. Analysts should also be cautious when

interpreting IP addresses and user agents because some SharePoint events may reference Microsoft infrastructure rather than the actual client device.

 **External file sharing deserves particular attention.** Operations such as `AddedToSecureLink` and `AnonymousLinkCreated` can reveal files being shared outside the organization. Following these events with `SecureLinkUsed`, `AnonymousLinkUsed`, or `FileAccessed` can help determine whether an external recipient actually accessed the shared content.

 **Data exfiltration can happen through normal SharePoint functionality.** An attacker with a compromised account may browse folders, open sensitive documents, download files, or share them through external links. A sudden increase in `FileDownloaded` events can therefore become an important detection signal, particularly when multiple files are downloaded within a short timeframe.

 **External applications introduce another detection opportunity.** Tools such as Rclone can be used to synchronize large amounts of SharePoint content to another location. Monitoring `ApplicationDisplayName` and `UserAgent` can help identify unusual applications interacting with SharePoint, especially when CLI-based tools appear in an environment where they are rarely used.

 **SharePoint can also become an attack delivery mechanism.** A compromised account may create or modify documents—such as OneNote files—and share them with targeted users. Because SharePoint notification emails can appear trustworthy, attackers can abuse this workflow to distribute phishing links or malicious content.

 **Incident response requires building the complete timeline.** A strong investigation connects events such as file creation or modification → external sharing → link usage → file access → additional downloads. Looking at individual events in isolation can miss attacker activity, especially when an existing file is modified instead of creating a new one.

 **The SOC takeaway:** SharePoint monitoring is not simply about watching for suspicious downloads. Effective detection combines **Entra ID authentication, M365 audit activity, file operations, external sharing, application usage, and chronological correlation** to identify both data theft and abuse of trusted cloud services.

 **For SOC analysts, the goal is to connect the dots:** suspicious login → SharePoint access → sensitive file discovery → download or sharing → external access → potential phishing or exfiltration. This approach provides stronger visibility into cloud-based attacks and helps reduce the risk of sensitive organizational data leaving the environment.

#CyberSecurity #SOC #SOCAnalyst #SOCLevel2 #ThreatHunting #Splunk #SIEM
#Microsoft365 #SharePoint #EntraID #CloudSecurity #DataExfiltration #Phishing
#IncidentResponse #CyberDefense #ThreatDetection #TryHackMe